
Film Title

When (inciting incident),

(hero) struggles against (antagonistic force)

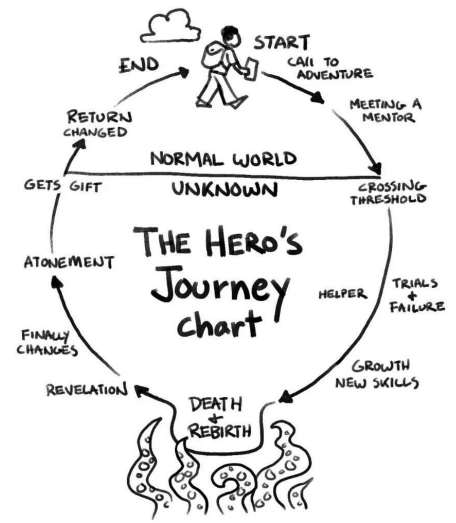
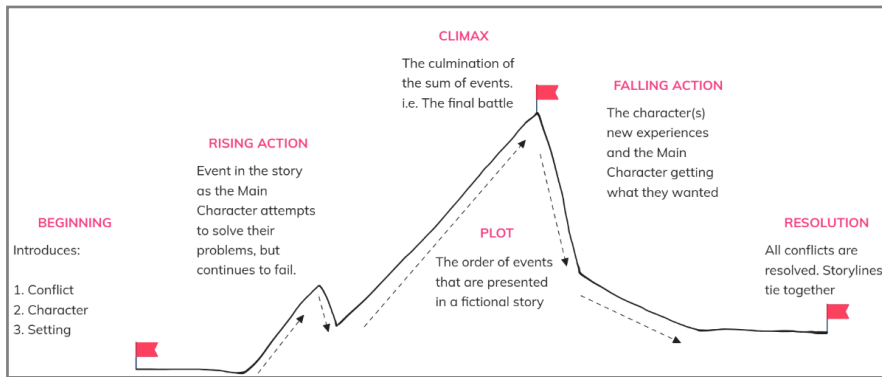
in order to (goal)

before (stakes are lost)

Author

Year

Development



Start

Call to Adventure

Meeting a Mentor

Crossing Threshold

Trials & Failure

Helper

Growth & New Skills

Death & Rebirth

Revelation

Finally Changes

Atonement

Gets Gift

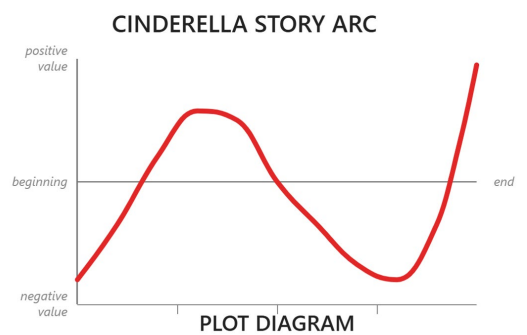
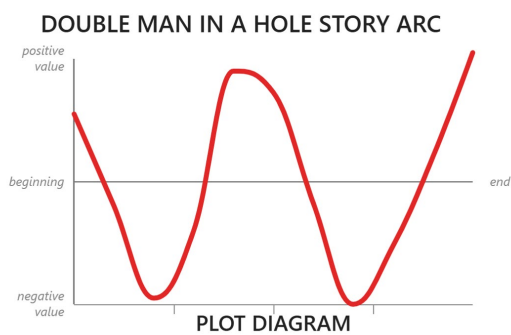
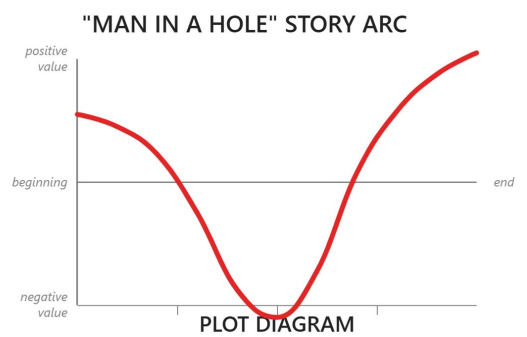
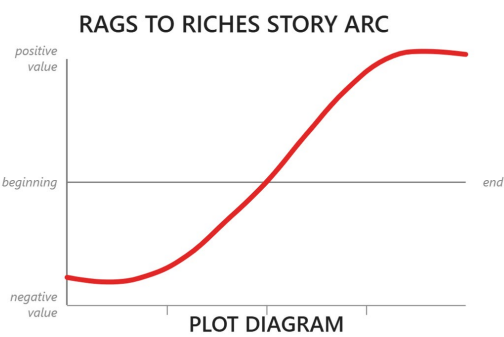
Return Changed

End

Story Arc



Examples



Primary Character Arcs

	Change	Steadfast
Positive	Name: _____ Name: _____ Name: _____	Name: _____ Name: _____ Name: _____
Negative	Name: _____ Name: _____ Name: _____	Name: _____ Name: _____ Name: _____

Examples

	Change	Steadfast
Positive		
Negative		

Story Outline

Brainstorm scenes using the 14 Hero's Journey beats before building your scene list or script.

This section comes before your scene list and screenplay.

Each beat helps you brainstorm possible scenes, choices, conflicts, surprises, images, and character changes.

Later, you'll choose the strongest ideas and arrange them into a scene list.



Remember

- Some Ideas may disappear later, and that's ok.
- Focus on what the audience can see & hear!

Who's the story about?

What does everyday life look like / what should the audience know / what introduces the character's world?

Scene Ideas

Notes, dialogue ideas, visual ideas, character moments

What problem or invitation pulls them into the story?

What disrupts ordinary life / makes the story begin / can no longer be ignored?

Scene Ideas

Notes, dialogue ideas, visual ideas, character moments

Meeting a Mentor

Who gives them advice, training, direction, or inspiration?

Who gives advice, training, direction, warning, encouragement, or inspiration?

Scene Ideas

Notes, dialogue ideas, visual ideas, character moments

Crossing the Threshold

What moment sends them into the unknown?

What choice commits them to the journey / creates a point of no return / moves them into a new situation?

Scene Ideas

Notes, dialogue ideas, visual ideas, character moments

What challenge(s) force them to grow?

What obstacles test them / where do they fail or struggle / what shows difficulty instead of instant success?

Scene Ideas

Notes, dialogue ideas, visual ideas, character moments

A Helper

Who joins or supports them along the way?

Who stands with them / changes the journey / helps build an important relationship?

Scene Ideas

Notes, dialogue ideas, visual ideas, character moments

What new skill, courage, or lesson do they gain?

What changes inside them / what do they learn to do or believe / how can growth be seen?

Scene Ideas

Notes, dialogue ideas, visual ideas, character moments

What is their lowest point, where they almost give up?

What feels lost / why does this moment hurt / what makes the audience wonder whether they will continue?

Scene Ideas

Notes, dialogue ideas, visual ideas, character moments

What truth do they finally understand?

What do they see clearly now / what were they wrong about before / what reveals the truth?

Scene Ideas

Notes, dialogue ideas, visual ideas, character moments

What choice proves they have changed?

What decision would they not have made at the beginning / what action proves the change / what shows the new self replacing the old self?

Scene Ideas

Notes, dialogue ideas, visual ideas, character moments

Who or what do they make right?

What relationship, mistake, or wrong must be repaired / who needs reconciliation or justice / what gets made right?

Scene Ideas

Notes, dialogue ideas, visual ideas, character moments

What have they gained, received, or brought back?

Is the gift an object, truth, skill, courage, relationship, or opportunity / how is it received or earned / why does it matter?

Scene Ideas

Notes, dialogue ideas, visual ideas, character moments

Return Changed

How does everyday life show that they've changed?

Where do they return / how is normal life different now / what shows the change in action?

Scene Ideas

Notes, dialogue ideas, visual ideas, character moments

Who notices the change, and what is different going forward?

What final image summarizes the story / who recognizes the difference / what should the audience remember?

Scene Ideas

Notes, dialogue ideas, visual ideas, character moments

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What final image summarizes the story / who recognizes the difference / what should the audience remember?

Scene Ideas

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Scene Planning

Now, put your scene ideas into the order the audience will experience them. This becomes the map for your screenplay draft.

How to use it

- List each scene in story order.
- Connect each scene to a journey step.
- Keep each scene description short.
- Combine scenes that do the same job.



Ask of every scene...

- Does something change?
- Does it reveal character?
- Does it move the story forward?
- Can the audience see or hear what happens?

Scene List

Scene #	Journey Step	Location	Characters	What Happens?
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				
9				
10				
11				
12				
13				
14				
15				
16				
17				

Screenplay Guide



Screenplays use special formatting so a film crew can quickly understand what appears on screen.

Screenplay Vocabulary Guide

FADE IN:	The screen begins black, then the image slowly appears.
FADE OUT:	The image fades away. Often used at the end.
INT.	Interior. The scene is inside.
EXT.	Exterior. The scene is outside.
Slugline (Scene Heading)	The line that tells where and when the scene happens.
Action	What the audience can see or hear, usually in present tense.
Character Cue	The name of the character speaking, usually centered and capitalized.
Dialogue	The words the character says.
Parenthetical	A short note about how a line is said or what the character is doing.
V.O.	Voice-over: A voice the audience hears that is not visible in the scene.
O.S.	Off-screen. The character is in the scene but not visible.
SUPER	Text appears over the image, like a date, place, or title card.

Simple Example

FADE IN:

EXT. FOREST PATH - DAY

A young boy runs through the trees, clutching a torn map.

JONAH

Wait for me!

He trips, falls, and looks back toward the sound of footsteps.

SUPER: THREE HOURS EARLIER

Write what the audience can see and hear. Save long explanations for your outline notes, not the screenplay page.